

Skills

Drawing up More than One Type of Insulin

Checklist

Checklist

S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Reviewed the MAR. Reviewed the types of insulin ordered including the onset, peak, duration of action, nursing implications, and compatibility when mixed.	☐	☐	☐	
For subcutaneous injections, assessed the patient's body build, muscle size, and weight.	☐	☐	☐	
Timed preparation and administration correctly, took mealtimes into consideration.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene, and prepared supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Followed agency's "No Interruption Zone" policy.	☐	☐	☐	
Selected the ordered insulins from the medication cart or automated dispensing system. Compared insulin vial labels with the MAR.	☐	☐	☐	
Checked the expiration date on the vials.	☐	☐	☐	
If it had been refrigerated, allowed the insulin to come to room temperature.	☐	☐	☐	
Prepared insulin for one patient at a time, and followed the Rights of Medication Administration.	☐	☐	☐	
Verified the labels of the insulin and the amounts drawn up in the syringe with the MAR.	☐	☐	☐	
When mixing rapid- or short-acting insulin with intermediate-acting insulin, prepared the injection as follows: 1. Calculated the total volume of insulin needed. 2. Asked another registered nurse to verify the types of insulins and calculations. 3. Rolled the vial between hands. 4. Removed the cap covering the top of an unused vial to expose the rubber seal. Wiped off the top of the rapid- or short-acting insulin with a sterile 70% isopropyl alcohol, ethyl alcohol,	☐	☐	☐	

iodophor, or other approved antiseptic swab and allowed to dry at least 10 seconds.

5. For insulin suspension preparations, rolled the vial between palms to redistribute medication. Removed the cap covering the top of an unused vial to expose the rubber seal. Wiped off the insulin with a new sterile 70% isopropyl alcohol, ethyl alcohol, iodophor, or other approved antiseptic swab and allowed to dry at least 10 seconds.
6. Picked up the insulin syringe with a preattached needle. Aspirated a volume of air equal to the total amount of intermediate insulin to be administered.
7. Inserted the needle of the syringe into the longer-acting insulin. Did not allow the needle tip to touch the solution in the vial. Injected a volume of air equal to the amount of intermediate insulin that would be given. Immediately withdrew the needle, without aspirating any medication.
8. Inserted the needle of the same syringe into the short- or rapid-acting insulin. Injected the remaining amount of air into the vial. Inverted the vial of the rapid- or short-acting insulin, with the needle still inserted, and drew up the ordered amount of the rapid- or short-acting insulin.
9. Removed the syringe from the vial of rapid- or short-acting insulin.
10. Verified the short-acting insulin dosage with the MAR. Showed the insulin prepared in the syringe to another nurse to verify that the correct dosage had been prepared.
11. Determined the point on the syringe scale to which the combined units of insulin should reach. Verified the combined dose.
12. Placed the needle of the syringe back into the vial of intermediate- or long-acting insulin. Did not push the plunger and inject insulin from the syringe into the vial.
13. Inverted the vial and carefully withdrew the desired amount of insulin into the syringe. Did not overdraw or push any insulin in the syringe back into the vial.
14. Withdrew the needle, and checked the volume in the syringe. Verified the volume with another registered nurse. Kept the needle of the prepared syringe sheathed or capped.

If insulin was prepared away from the patient's bedside, labeled the syringe with the name of each insulin in the syringe.

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Did a third accuracy check against the MAR at the patient's bedside.

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Disposed of used supplies.

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Performed hand hygiene.

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Documented the procedure in the patient's record.

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Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____